



Air Quality Situation Report

Edmonton Folk Music Festival ·
Gallagher Park

Wed, Aug 12, 2026 · 6:12 AM MDT
For more information, contact Gary Redmond, ACA Executive Director at 780.935.4279

Air Quality Health Index (AQHI) — Edmonton

2.0

Current AQHI at Edmonton McCauley (1.66 km from venue)
Forecast Wed 8:00 AM: 1.5

Health Risk	AQHI	At-Risk Population	General Population
Low Risk	2.0	Enjoy your usual outdoor activities.	Ideal air quality for outdoor activities.

No active Environment Canada weather alerts for the venue.

Environmental Intelligence Summary

- At Edmonton Folk Music Festival, temperature is 11.1°C and feels near 10.8°C. Winds are 4 km/h from W, gusting near 11 km/h.
- The nearest current AQHI is 2 at Edmonton McCauley, 1.7 km from the venue.
- The official Government of Alberta AQHI for Edmonton is 1 (forecast tonight: 2, tomorrow: 3).
- A gridded AQHI estimate blending official and community sensors (confidence: High) puts the area near 1.
- The nearest air monitoring station (Edmonton McCauley, 1.7 km) reports fine particulate matter (PM2.5) at 9.1 µg/m³.
- An on-site community sensor ('ACA_EFMF-Office', 0.3 km) reads 8.0 µg/m³ PM2.5.
- Back-trajectory modeling (HRDPS wind fields, 6 h lookback) indicates the air currently at the venue traveled from the vicinity of a point 106.3 km to the NE, i.e. arriving from the NE.
- The nearest active fire detection (NASA FIRMS – VIIRS, last 2026-08-11) is 6.1 km E of the venue. The modeled back-trajectory passes within 5.1 km of this fire, making smoke transport to the venue plausible based on wind-field modeling.
- The AQHI forecast for Wed 8:00 AM is 2.
- Thunderstorm conditions appear in the hourly forecast beginning around Wed 5:00 PM.
- Overall operational environmental risk is HIGH. Primary concerns are precipitation, thunderstorm.

Recommendations

- Confirm lightning monitoring, shelter, pause and evacuation procedures.
- Prepare drainage, electrical protection and wet-weather controls.
- Environment Canada AQHI guidance — general population: Ideal air quality for outdoor activities.
- Environment Canada AQHI guidance — at-risk populations: Enjoy your usual outdoor activities.

Hazard Snapshot — Overall Risk: High Risk

AIR QUALITY Low Risk 2.0 AQHI	HEAT Low Risk 19.2 °C apparent/humidex	WIND Low Risk 31.7 km/h peak gust	PRECIPITATION High Risk 3.6 mm/h maximum	THUNDERSTORM High Risk Wed 5:00 PM first forecast signal
AQHI RATE OF CHANGE Low Risk 0.0 AQHI change/hour			WIND SHEAR Low Risk 42.8 ° direction diff (10m vs 120m)	

Local Monitoring

Nearest station 2.0 Edmonton McCauley · 1.66 km	Blended estimate 1.0 confidence High	PM2.5 (station) 9.1 µg/m³ Edmonton McCauley · 1.66 km	PM2.5 (community) 8.0 µg/m³ ACA_EFMF-Office · 0.31 km
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